of were resurrected and put into effect. Infrastructure works were undertaken on a war footing to build up oxygen plants and generators, which were critical in the fight against Covid.

In this manner, working closely with all other ministries and state governments, we were surely and steadily able to claw our way out of the panic that had set in with the devastating second wave. Simultaneously, the inoculation of all personnel was begun, which afforded a degree of protection. It had to be emphasized though, that the inoculation does not make a person immune to Covid but only diminishes the severity of the attack and therefore, precautionary measures were still absolutely essential. Though our (country's) absolute figures of deaths seemed high, it was not so when seen in percentage terms. The US, for example, with half our population, had twice the number of deaths. India as a country, through a 'Whole of Nation' effort, had beaten back the pandemic, faring much better than so-called developed nations. Something we can truly be proud of.

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Revolution in Bureaucratic Affairs

The term 'Revolution in Military Affairs' (RMA) has been around since the early 2000s. It envisaged a rapid transformation in the entire spectrum in which militaries the world over operate, from doctrine to strategy to tactics, under the influence of technological change. It also aimed at harnessing the power of technology to increase operational effectiveness, bring about efficiency, and minimize casualties and collateral damage. This is what I meant when I had said many times over that we too needed to move from a 'manpower-intensive, to a technologically empowered Service.'[13] However, this transformation would not be possible in a system mired in red